

Daily Market Report

Thursday, June 18, 2026 - After Market Close | Singapore

SECTION 1 - Market Summary

Index	Closing Price	Day	1 Week	1 Month	1 Year	52W High	52W Low
S&P 500 (SPY)	746.74	+0.78%	+1.22%	+1.77%	+24.52%	759.57	594.28
Nasdaq 100 (QQQ)	740.62	+2.51%	+3.28%	+5.57%	+39.56%	746.16	526.83
VIX	18.44	+12.37%	-17.01%	+2.10%	+7.46%	31.05	13.47

Thursday's session saw a powerful tech-led rebound as the Nasdaq 100 (NDX) surged +2.51% (QQQ: \$740.62), recovering much of the prior day's FOMC-driven selloff, powered by a historic Intel-Apple domestic chip deal announced by President Trump and a broad semiconductor rally. The S&P 500 (SPY) added +0.78% to \$746.74, with the Technology sector leading all groups at +3.04%, while Energy (-1.65%) and Financials (-0.89%) lagged on the US-Iran MOU signing and Accenture-led IT services concerns.

SECTION 1B - Early Warning

Signal	Status	What It Means
VIX (fear gauge)	GREEN	18.4 - calm
Breadth (sectors up)	AMBER	5/11 sectors green - mixed
S&P vs 50-day avg	GREEN	+2.3% vs trend
Consumer confidence	GREY	N/A - set manually in config
10Y Treasury yield	GREEN	4.49%

Overall: **HEALTHY**

SECTION 2 - Stock Spotlights

Micron Technology (MU)

Metric	Value
Closing Price	1133.99
Day Change	+8.70%
52W High	1133.99
52W Low	104.88
P/E Ratio	53.4
Dividend Yield	N/A
Analyst View	strong_buy
Analyst Target	\$1,015.34 (Benzinga/30-analyst consensus, June 18, 2026); most recent: avg \$1,333.33 from Rosenblatt, Stifel & Wedbush (June 18, 2026)
Next Earnings	Jun 24, 2026
Beta (1Y)	2.98

HOLD - MU closed at its 52-week high of \$1,133.99, well above the Benzinga/30-analyst consensus target of ~\$1,015 and the S&P Global 44-analyst average of \$945.60, meaning the stock has materially outrun near-term Street models even as the bull case strengthens into its Q3 earnings on June 24. Momentum is exceptional — up +8.7% on Thursday alone, +922% over 12 months — powered by AI-driven HBM and DRAM demand and record Q2 results including \$12.20 EPS (beating \$8.60 consensus by 42%) and Q3 guidance of \$33.5B revenue with ~81% gross margin. Key risk is the extreme high-beta (2.98) valuation at all-time highs heading into an earnings event where the bar is now very high, and any guidance miss or DRAM/NAND supply reversal could trigger a sharp reversal.

SECTION 3 - Watchlist

Ticker	Company	Price	Day	1 Week	1 Month	1 Year	52W Low	52W High	Beta
SPCX	SpaceX	185.0	-3.56%	+37.04%	N/A	+37.04%	135.0	211.39	N/A
NVDA	Nvidia	210.69	+2.95%	+2.84%	-4.50%	+47.72%	141.97	235.74	1.84
AMD	AMD	537.37	+4.86%	+10.02%	+29.78%	+341.44%	116.16	547.26	2.87
AVGO	Broadcom	411.35	+4.70%	+6.69%	+0.07%	+68.39%	244.28	481.57	2.1
GOOGL	Alphabet	368.03	+1.17%	+2.87%	-5.06%	+109.00%	165.19	402.62	1.3
IBM	IBM	249.1	-5.05%	-9.37%	+12.04%	-8.45%	214.64	329.23	1.04
MSFT	Microsoft	379.4	+0.13%	-2.80%	-9.11%	-19.75%	356.77	542.07	0.88
INTC	Intel	133.99	+10.64%	+14.56%	+20.93%	+554.25%	19.31	133.99	2.54
C	Citigroup	143.06	-0.50%	+3.61%	+19.25%	+83.01%	76.36	143.78	1.37
QRVO	Qorvo	98.42	+3.98%	+0.78%	+4.07%	+21.37%	76.02	108.23	1.25
ANET	Arista Networks	169.67	+2.87%	+8.48%	+19.84%	+75.28%	86.25	177.73	2.07
WQTM	Quantum ETF (WQTM)	37.81	+3.11%	+3.22%	+15.31%	+24.83%	23.32	41.31	2.38
GFS	GlobalFoundries	85.83	+6.44%	+6.30%	+28.72%	+123.57%	31.62	89.96	2.04

SECTION 4 - Why Markets Moved

Thursday's US session delivered a broad-based recovery led by technology and chip stocks. The Nasdaq 100 (NDX/QQQ) jumped +2.51%, the S&P 500 gained +1.08%, and the Russell 2000 outperformed at +2.12%. The day's single biggest catalyst was President Trump's Truth Social post confirming Intel (INTC) will design and manufacture chips domestically alongside Apple (AAPL), sending INTC surging +10.64% to a new 52-week high of \$133.99. The Philadelphia Semiconductor Index hit a record high. Separately, the US-Iran MOU signing in France eased geopolitical risk, though it weighed on Energy stocks (-1.65%) as oil edged lower. IBM (IBM) fell -5.05% after peer Accenture's weak outlook and IBM's own study revealing enterprise AI control gaps spooked IT services investors.

The rebound came one day after a sharp Fed-driven selloff. In its first meeting under new Chair Kevin Warsh, the FOMC held rates steady but delivered a hawkish dot plot — nine of eighteen policymakers projected at least one rate hike before year-end, and the Fed signalled slower growth and higher inflation in its updated projections. Markets initially sold off hard on June 17, but Thursday's session saw investors 'buy the dip,' particularly in semiconductors and AI-infrastructure names where earnings fundamentals remain powerful. Micron's upcoming Q3 report (June 24) is guiding for record \$33.5B revenue and ~81% gross margin, providing a strong fundamental floor for the sector. The VIX spiked +12.37% on the day to 18.44 — still 'green'/calm — but the week-on-week VIX decline of -17.01% confirms that the Fed shock was absorbed rather than becoming a structural market event.

For overseas retail investors, Thursday's session reveals a market in transition: the AI chip/semiconductor complex remains the dominant upside driver, but macro uncertainty around a possible Fed rate hike in late 2026 means high-beta tech names carry genuine two-sided risk. The Trump-Intel-Apple deal is the year's most significant industrial-policy catalyst for US semiconductors, validating the domestic chip renaissance trade and lifting INTC, AMD, and AVGO in sympathy. Investors should remain alert to the upcoming Micron (MU) earnings on June 24 — the most important near-term single-stock catalyst for the entire AI memory trade — while monitoring the 10-year Treasury yield (currently 4.49%) as the primary macro risk signal. The NDX's quarterly rebalance on June 22, adding ALAB, CRWV, NBIS, RKLK, and TER, will create mechanical index-fund buying pressure at the open next Monday.

SECTION 5 - Sector Rotation & Macro

Winners

- Technology: **+3.04%**
- Consumer Disc: **+1.45%**
- Industrials: **+0.73%**

Losers

- Financials: **-0.89%**
- Energy: **-1.65%**

Macro

- Fed turns hawkish under new Chair Warsh: The FOMC left benchmark rates unchanged at its June meeting but updated projections show 9 of 18 policymakers favour at least one rate hike before year-end, signalling the rate-cut narrative that markets had priced in is now off the table for 2026. The 10-year Treasury yield at 4.49% is the critical line to watch — a sustained break above 4.75% would re-price equity multiples across all growth sectors.

- US-Iran MOU signed in France: The US and Iran signed a memorandum of understanding, easing one of the key geopolitical risk premia of 2026. This is net-positive for global supply chains and inflation (lower energy risk premium), but the deal is preliminary and energy markets remain cautious with crude oil at ~\$75.56/barrel. A failure to ratify or an escalation re-entry would quickly reverse energy price declines.
- Trump's domestic chip industrial policy accelerating: President Trump confirmed on Truth Social that Apple has agreed to work with Intel to design and manufacture chips in the US, sending INTC to all-time highs and lifting the Philadelphia Semiconductor Index to a record. The US government holds a 10% stake in Intel and has committed ~\$10 billion in factory investment, blurring the line between government and private market. Upcoming data catalysts: Q1 GDP revision and May PCE inflation (end of June) will be critical for the Fed's rate path.

SECTION 6 - Earnings Calendar

Watchlist stocks verified. Broader NDX dates sourced via web search - confirm before trading.

Company	Ticker	Next Earnings	
Micron Technology	MU	Jun 24, 2026	WATCHLIST
FedEx	FDX	Jun 25, 2026	
Carnival Corp	CCL	Jun 23, 2026	
General Mills	GIS	Jun 25, 2026	
Astera Labs	ALAB	Jul 28, 2026	
CoreWeave	CRWV	Aug 11, 2026	
Rocket Lab	RKLB	Aug 6, 2026	
Nvidia	NVDA	Aug 27, 2026	
Broadcom	AVGO	Sep 3, 2026	
Alphabet	GOOGL	Jul 28, 2026	
Microsoft	MSFT	Jul 29, 2026	
Intel	INTC	Jul 24, 2026	

SECTION 6B - Opportunity Radar

- **Domestic Semiconductor Renaissance** - Trump's Intel-Apple chip deal and the US government's ~\$10B Intel foundry investment are catalysing a structural re-rating of US-domestic chip manufacturers. The Philadelphia Semiconductor Index hit an all-time record on June 18. INTC is up +554% year-on-year and still at its 52-week high, while GlobalFoundries (GFS) — a domestic wafer fab — is up +28.72% in a month and +123.57% over a year, approaching its 52-week high of \$89.96. (e.g. GFS)
- **AI Memory & HBM Supercycle** - Micron's Q3 guidance of \$33.5B revenue with ~81% gross margin confirms the AI-driven HBM/DRAM demand cycle is still accelerating. Consensus 2026 net income for MU is forecast to grow 251% versus just 38% for the broader US semiconductor industry. AMD has surged +29.78% in a month and +341.44% over a year on AI GPU and server processor wins, near its 52-week high of \$547.26. (e.g. AMD)
- **AI Infrastructure / Data-Centre Networking NDX Rebalance** - The NDX June 22 quarterly rebalance adds ALAB, CRWV, NBIS, RCLB, and TER, triggering mechanical index-fund purchases from open on Monday. Arista Networks (ANET) — already in the NDX — is up +8.48% this week and +19.84% this month, as data-centre networking demand from hyperscalers accelerates; its peer Marvell (MRVL) saw KeyBanc raise its target from \$260 to \$385 citing data-centre networking as a 'major growth driver.' (e.g. ANET)

With the VIX at a calm 18.44 (GREEN), the S&P 500 trading +2.3% above its 50-day moving average (GREEN), and the 10-year Treasury yield at 4.49% (GREEN), the overall market health signal is HEALTHY and near-term correction risk is low — conditions that favour staying invested in quality growth. However, the FOMC's hawkish pivot (9 of 18 dots for a 2026 rate hike), mixed breadth (only 5 of 11 sectors green), and MSFT's -19.75% 12-month return despite being the index bellwether are early warnings that the leadership is narrowing dangerously around AI-chip plays. The recommended posture is: BUY quality AI infrastructure and domestic semiconductor names on any dip (INTC, GFS, ANET, AMD); HOLD broad index exposure via QQQ/SPY as the macro still supports growth; REDUCE single-stock concentration in over-consensus-target names (MU at all-time highs, IBM in correction) and add selective fixed-income exposure (short-to-intermediate Treasuries at 4.49% offer attractive risk-adjusted yield) as a hedge against the Fed's higher-for-longer pivot.

SECTION 7 - Stocks to Watch

INTC | Price: \$133.99 | **BUY** | Horizon: 5-YEAR

President Trump confirmed an Apple-Intel domestic chip manufacturing deal on June 18, lifting INTC to a new 52-week high of \$133.99 (+554% YoY) and marking a historic commercial validation of Intel's foundry turnaround; with the US government owning a 10% stake and committing ~\$10B in factory investment, INTC has a powerful policy tailwind for years. Intel's 18A-P process has entered risk production — the clearest sign yet that the manufacturing roadmap is on track — and further wins from NVDA or GOOGL as foundry clients could trigger the next leg of re-rating.

AMD | Price: \$537.37 | **BUY** | Horizon: 1-YEAR

AMD has surged +341.44% over 12 months and +29.78% in the past month on AI GPU wins and server processor market share gains, sitting just below its 52-week high of \$547.26 at \$537.37; near-term momentum is exceptional and data-centre AI capex from hyperscalers continues to expand the addressable market. However, with beta of 2.87 and price now near all-time highs, the 1-year horizon is preferred — monitor for any softening in AI server order trends or NVDA competitive pressure before adding size.

ANET | Price: \$169.67 | **BUY** | Horizon: 1-YEAR

Arista Networks is up +8.48% this week and +19.84% this month, driven by explosive demand for data-centre networking from AI hyperscalers; with a beta of 2.07 and 75.28% 12-month return, it is a high-quality way to play AI infrastructure without direct chip-cycle inventory risk. Arista is still ~4.5% below its 52-week high of \$177.73, giving room to run before resistance, and its revenue model is underpinned by multi-year cloud backbone build-outs that will persist regardless of which chip vendor wins.

GOOGL | Price: \$368.03 | **HOLD** | Horizon: 1-YEAR

Alphabet at \$368.03 is up +109% over 12 months but has pulled back -5.06% over the past month as regulatory and AI-competition concerns weigh; at a beta of 1.30 it is one of the lower-volatility AI mega-caps and trades comfortably below its 52-week high of \$402.62, offering reasonable value for patient investors. Hold rather than add aggressively here given the hawkish Fed backdrop compressing multiples, but do not sell — GOOGL's Waymo, DeepMind, and Cloud AI revenues provide multiple catalysts for re-rating in the second half of 2026.

IBM | Price: \$249.1 | **SELL** | Horizon: EXIT NOW

IBM fell -5.05% on June 18 and is down -9.37% for the week, -8.45% over 12 months — the only major AI name with negative annual returns in our coverage — weighed down by Accenture's weak guidance, IBM's own study showing 91% of enterprise AI executives don't understand their AI dependencies, and a sharp technical correction of ~24% from the \$329.23 52-week high. With IBM's Consulting division growing just 1% in Q1 2026 and the hawkish Fed placing additional pressure on enterprise IT budgets, the monetisation runway for watsonx and hybrid cloud is deteriorating; exit and redeploy into higher-conviction AI infrastructure plays.

SECTION 8 - Market Trends

Thursday's session confirmed the US market's resilience: a +2.51% NDX rebound the day after a Fed-shock selloff, led by semiconductors hitting all-time records, shows that institutional buyers view AI-chip earnings power as a stronger force than near-term rate risk. The mixed breadth signal — only 5 of 11 sectors green, with Energy and Financials under pressure

— suggests leadership remains dangerously narrow, concentrated in the semiconductor and AI infrastructure cluster, meaning the bull market's durability depends on that cluster's earnings continuing to impress when MU reports on June 24 and NDX heavyweights report through July and August.

Upside Risks

- Micron Q3 earnings beat on June 24: MU guided for record \$33.5B revenue and ~81% gross margin with EPS of ~\$19.15; a beat (MU has beaten consensus in 82 of 157 quarters) would likely trigger a sector-wide AI memory rally, re-rating NVDA, AMD, and AVGO higher simultaneously.
- NDX rebalance mechanical buying: Five new additions (ALAB, CRWV, NBIS, RKL, TER) become effective June 22, triggering mandatory index-fund purchases; RKL alone has a \$2.2B backlog record and Neutron missions priced at \$50-55M, suggesting material upside from forced institutional accumulation.
- US-Iran deal reduces energy/inflation risk premium: The MOU signing in France introduces the possibility of renewed Iranian oil supply, which if formalised could bring crude oil meaningfully lower from ~\$75.56, reducing the Fed's inflation concerns and pushing back the rate-hike timeline — a bullish macro reset for growth equities.

Downside Risks

- Fed rate hike materialises in H2 2026: With 9 of 18 FOMC policymakers already projecting a hike and inflation 'at its highest level in three years' (per Investing.com), a single hot PCE or CPI print in late June/July could accelerate the tightening timeline, compressing the P/E multiples of NDX components trading at 40-53x earnings.
- Bank of America warns of narrowing leadership: BofA analysts flagged that 'rising valuations and narrowing leadership could leave investors increasingly vulnerable' — with only 5 of 11 sectors green and IBM, MSFT both underperforming over 12 months, a rotation shock triggered by any disappointment in the AI-chip cluster could cascade quickly given concentrated index weights.
- Intel-Apple deal confirmation risk: Neither Apple nor Intel issued an official statement confirming the Trump-announced chip deal as of June 18; the arrangement is based on a preliminary WSJ report from May 2026. A formal denial or material delay in the partnership would erase INTC's +10.64% single-day gain and remove the sector tailwind that drove Thursday's Philadelphia Semiconductor Index record.

SECTION 9 - Portfolio Allocation (5-8 Year Horizon)

With VIX at a calm 18.44, the S&P 500 +2.3% above its 50-day average, and the 10-year Treasury at an attractive 4.49%, current conditions support a growth-tilted but increasingly defensive allocation for a 5-8 year retirement horizon — one that harvests AI and technology upside while building a meaningful fixed-income and dividend buffer against the Fed's clear hawkish pivot and the risk that narrow market leadership eventually broadens or reverses. As J.P. Morgan's 2026 Long-Term

Capital Market Assumptions project a 6.9% return for portfolios adding a 30% alternatives/bond sleeve, this allocation blends growth capture with sequence-of-returns risk management appropriate for a professional approaching retirement.

Bucket	Allocation %	Purpose
US Large-Cap Growth Equities (AI/Tech Leaders)	30%	Core growth engine targeting AI infrastructure, semiconductor, and mega-cap tech leaders (NVDA, AMD, ANET, INTC, AVGO, QQQ ETF); provides the primary capital appreciation driver over the 5-8 year horizon while remaining highly liquid for tactical rebalancing.
US Large-Cap Quality / Dividend Equities	20%	Dividend-paying blue-chips and low-beta quality names (GOOGL, MSFT once momentum stabilises, Citigroup C) providing income, lower correlation to the AI-chip cycle, and inflation protection through pricing power; targets beta below 1.3.
Short-to-Intermediate US Treasuries & Investment-Grade Bonds	25%	At 4.49% on the 10-year, Treasuries offer the best risk-adjusted yield in years; concentrate in 2-5 year duration to avoid long-duration rate risk if the Fed hikes, generating reliable income while preserving principal as retirement approaches; avoid 20-30 year bonds given higher-for-longer rate environment.
International Developed Market Equities	10%	Diversification away from US-specific AI concentration risk and USD exposure; MSCI EAFE remains below its February 2026 highs but has recovered strongly, and with the dollar showing structural weakness, unhedged international exposure adds currency diversification for overseas investors.
Alternatives & Real Assets (Commodities / Energy / REITs)	8%	Hedge against the residual inflation and energy-supply risks flagged by Fidelity's midyear outlook; energy equities may be underpriced if the Iran MOU fails to deliver oil supply; REITs provide inflation-linked income; allocation reduces correlation to both equity and bond portfolios.
Quantum Computing & Emerging Tech ETF (WQTM / thematic)	5%	High-risk / high-reward thematic satellite position in the next technology wave; WQTM is up +15.31% in a month and +24.83% over 12 months with a beta of 2.38 — size is deliberately small to limit drawdown impact but provides asymmetric upside if quantum computing commercialisation accelerates within the 5-8 year horizon.
Cash & Money Market / Short-Term Bills	2%	Liquidity buffer and dry-powder reserve to exploit tactical opportunities (e.g., post-MU earnings dip, NDX rebalance-driven pullbacks); at current Fed fund rates, cash earns a meaningful risk-free return while maintaining flexibility for opportunistic rebalancing.

Rebalance Trigger: Initiate a full portfolio rebalance if ANY of the following occur: (1) VIX closes above 25 for two consecutive sessions, signalling a risk-off regime change requiring rotation from growth equities into Treasuries; (2) the 10-year Treasury yield breaks above 4.80%, warranting a 5-percentage-point shift from equities to short-duration bonds; (3) the S&P 500 (SPY) closes more than 8% below its 50-day moving average, triggering a 10-point reduction in the US Large-Cap Growth bucket with proceeds moved to Treasuries and cash; or (4) any single equity position exceeds 10% of total portfolio value, requiring trimming back to target weight.

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